HOT ROD FANTASY FOOTBALL BOYS

Week 1 Breakdown

The Rundown Week 1

🏆 **High Scorer of the Week**
Hannah — 145.22 pts

Hannah opened 2026 with the league's highest score and the first Week 1 win of her career. Her previous Week 1 performances averaged just 87.88 points, making this year's 145.22 a 57.34-point jump above her opening-week average.

The production came from across the lineup, with four starters topping 23 points, helping **Hannah** finish 35.42 points above her team's projection. The 145.22 also ranks as the 3rd-highest regular-season score of her career.

Still searching for her first playoff appearance, **Hannah** couldn't have asked for a much better opening statement: 1-0, highest score in the league, and one of the best performances she's ever posted.

🍀 **Lucky Break**
Bryan — 103.94 pts | 3–8 All-Play

Bryan escaped Week 1 with a win despite posting only the 9th-best score in the league, good for a 3–8 all-play record. He happened to draw **Dawson's** 93.66, and **Dawson** was also the only manager whose lineup decision would have changed the actual winner.

Historically, Week 1 hasn't been especially kind to **Bryan** either. From 2021–2025, he averaged just 95.46 points in season openers and went 1–4, with last year being his only Week 1 victory. His 103.94 this year is therefore 8.48 points above his historical Week 1 average and gives him consecutive opening-week wins for the first time.

The bigger takeaway may simply be that **Bryan** got the result he needed. He has historically been one of the league's best at recovering from 0–1 starts, but this time he avoids having to dig out of that hole at all.

🎲 **Not So Lucky**
Wayne — 112.30 pts | 6–5 All-Play

Wayne put up a solid 112.30 points, good for a winning 6–5 all-play record, but drew the worst possible opponent in **Hannah's** league-high 145.22.

The loss also ends a streak of two straight Week 1 wins. The last time **Wayne** opened a season 0-1 was 2023, when he eventually finished just 2-12, the worst regular-season record of the modern era.

That season is also the only time **Wayne** has started 0-2. If he loses again in Week 2, he'd match the same opening that preceded that two-win season.

One unlucky matchup doesn't mean history is about to repeat itself, but it definitely raises the stakes for Week 2.

🪑 **Bench Blunders**
Dawson leaves the win on the bench

Dawson's Week 1 loss to **Bryan** was the only matchup of the week that would have flipped with a different lineup decision. He started Makai Lemon, who scored 1.0 point, while Jalen Coker put up 30.3 on the bench. That one swap would have added 29.3 points, turning a 103.94–93.66 loss into a 122.96–103.94 win.

The miss matters a little more given **Dawson's** recent history. He won the league in 2024, then followed it with a 6-8 season and missed the playoffs in 2025 after starting 0-2.

Now back at 0-1, **Dawson** is trying to get back into the postseason picture. A loss in Week 2 to **Derrick** would put him at 0-2 for the second straight year, which makes that Week 1 lineup miss sting even more.

🎯 **Sharp Shooter**
Josh — 96.7% Lineup Efficiency

Josh made a strong first impression in his league debut, setting the best lineup in Week 1 at 96.7% efficiency. His 111.46 points were also the highest Week 1 debut score among the league's recent newcomers.

The result didn't cooperate, as he ran into **Brett's** 138.96, but there wasn't much left on the bench.

The rookie-year goal is still in front of him: **Josh** is hoping to become just the second newcomer to win the championship in his first season, joining **Jake** in 2023. Week 2 matters, though. None of the league's recent first-year managers have started 0-2, so a loss would put **Josh** in territory no newcomer has had to recover from yet.

Around the League

A High-Scoring Start

Week 1 opened 2026 with 1,339.27 total points, the second-highest opening week of the modern era and only 10.43 points shy of the 2021 record. **Hannah** led the league with 145.22, while **Brett** followed at 138.96.

Wins Aren't Always Pretty

Bryan escaped with a 103.94–93.66 win despite posting only the ninth-best score in the league and going 3–8 in all-play. On the other side, **Wayne** scored 112.30 and finished in the top half of league scoring, but still drew **Hannah's** league-high total.

Week 1 Already Left Some Regrets

Dawson's lineup decision was the only one that would have changed an actual result. Starting Jalen Coker over Makai Lemon would have added 29.3 points and flipped his loss to **Bryan** into a win. Josh also had a strong debut, scoring 111.46 with the league's best lineup efficiency at 96.7%, but ran into Brett's 138.96.

History Says More Points Are Coming

For five straight seasons, Week 2 has produced more scoring than Week 1. The average increase has been 69.25 league points, or 5.77 per team, setting up another potentially big scoring week after 2026 already posted the second-highest Week 1 total of the modern era.

LOOKING AHEAD

Week 2 is where the early-season paths begin to separate. Since 2021, teams starting 2-0 made the playoffs 72.2% of the time, compared with 54.2% at 1-1 and just 22.2% at 0-2.

Week 2: What's at Stake

Six matchups, six different pressure points. Week 2 brings two guaranteed 2-0 teams, two guaranteed 0-2 teams, and several managers trying to either repeat or avoid familiar early-season patterns.

John (1-0) vs. Josh (0-1)

John is chasing his first 2-0 start of the modern era. He has never opened 2-0 from 2021–25, despite making the playoffs twice. His most recent appearance came in 2024, when he went 10-4 and finished as runner-up. **Josh**, meanwhile, is trying to avoid becoming the first recent newcomer to begin his rookie season 0-2.

Bryan (1-0) vs. Ed (1-0)

Somehow, **Bryan** has never started 2-0, despite making the playoffs in four of five seasons and owning the most regular-season wins of the modern era. A win would give him his first. **Ed** has been 2-0 once before, in 2024, and reached the playoffs that season. One of them leaves Week 2 in the 72.2% historical playoff bucket.

Dawson (0-1) vs. Derrick (0-1)

Their histories at 0-2 could hardly be more different. **Dawson** has started 0-2 twice, recovering to make the playoffs in 2021 but missing at 6-8 last season. **Derrick** has gone 0-2 three times and missed the playoffs all three times. On the flip side, both of **Derrick's** previous 2-0 starts, 2021 and 2025, ended in playoff appearances. Somebody leaves this matchup in an early hole.

Lewis (0-1) vs. Castano (0-1)

Castano may be the league's resident 0-2 escape artist. He started 0-2 four consecutive seasons from 2021–24, yet recovered to make the playoffs twice, including his 2022 co-championship season. **Lewis** has only started 0-2 once, last year, and missed the postseason. One of them will be back there after Week 2.

Kyle (1-0) vs. Hannah (1-0)

Hannah has never been 2-0. Her first two seasons began 1-1 in 2024 and 0-2 in 2025, and both ended outside the playoffs. **Kyle** has only one season of history, but he began 2-0 in 2025 and eventually grabbed the league's final playoff spot, finishing one position ahead of **Hannah**. A **Hannah** win would give her the best start of her career and flip last year's early-season script.

Brett (1-0) vs. Wayne (0-1)

Brett has started 2-0 twice, 2023 and 2024, and made the playoffs both times. Another win would give him his first 2-0 opening since 2024. **Wayne** has only fallen to 0-2 once, in 2023, and that season spiraled into a 2-12 finish, the worst regular-season record of the modern era. He has plenty of proof that a slower start can be overcome, though: **Wayne** began 1-1 last season and went on to win the championship.

Historical playoff rates after Week 2
2-0: 72.2% | 1-1: 54.2% | 0-2: 22.2%

2026 RECORDS

High Score: Hannah — 145.22

Low Score: Lewis — 73.36

Biggest Blowout: Ed def. Lewis by 39.44

Closest Match: Bryan def. Dawson by 10.28

Highest Player Score: Caleb Williams (Brett) — 37.26

Highest Losing Score: Wayne — 112.30

Lowest Winning Score: Bryan — 103.94

Draft Picks Under the Microscope

BY THE NUMBERS

69.3 vs. 59.3
Average points from Rounds 1-4 for week 1 winners vs. losers
+10.0 points for 1-0 Teams

37.2 vs. 24.6
Average points from Rounds 5–9 for Week 1 winners vs. losers
+12.6 points for 1-0 teams

6.1%
Derrick got just 6.7 of his 110.6 points from his first two draft picks, well below the 29.6% league average and the lowest share in Week 1.

48.0%
Wayne got 53.9 of his 112.3 points from Rounds 1–2, well above the 29.6% league average and the highest share in Week 1.

3 TEAMS
Scored 100+ points from players drafted after Round 2:
Hannah 105.1 **Derrick** 103.9 **John** 101.1

105.1
Hannah led the league in points from Round 3+ starters.
The league-wide average was just 78.3 points, putting her 26.8 above average.



MANAGER		R1-R2	R3-R4	R5-R6	R7-R8	R9+	TOTAL
Hannah Greene	1-0	40.1	41.5	32.5	0.0	31.1	145.2
Brett Wilson	1-0	49.4	16.9	36.4	0.0	36.3	139.0
John Human	1-0	21.9	41.7	7.4	24.4	27.6	123.0
Kyle Kirchenbauer	1-0	47.3	27.6	3.1	25.9	9.1	113.0
Edwin Sical	1-0	31.6	13.6	16.3	33.1	18.2	112.8
Wayne Sinclair	0-1	53.9	20.7	12.0	10.3	15.4	112.3
Josh Escandon	0-1	36.7	36.3	6.3	30.2	2.0	111.5
Derrick Gregory	0-1	6.7	54.1	7.9	7.3	34.6	110.6
Bryan Genter	1-0	31.4	36.1	6.8	6.3	23.3	103.9
Jonathan Castano	0-1	43.8	6.8	26.6	3.6	20.2	101.0
Dawson Jordan	0-1	19.9	44.5	24.3	1.0	4.0	93.7
Lewis Farrara	0-1	16.7	15.9	13.4	0.0	27.4	73.4

HOT ROD FANTASY FOOTBALL BOYS

WEEK 1 STORYLINES

2026 WEEK 1

Hannah's Depth Delivers

Hannah led the league with 105.1 points from Round 3+ starters, but remarkably didn't lead the league in scoring from any single draft round. Instead, she got 27.4 from Round 4, 24.72 from Round 5 and 23.8 from Round 10, giving her high-end production from multiple parts of the draft.

Derrick Nearly Survives the Stars

Derrick got only 6.7 points from Rounds 1–2, just 6.1% of his total score, yet still finished with 110.60 points. His remaining starters produced 103.9, showing how much of his Week 1 lineup was carried by the rest of the draft.

John Finds Value Beyond the Top Two

John got just 21.9 points from his first two picks, but his next two selections, Nico Collins and Zay Flowers, combined for 41.7. He also got a league-best 19.0 points from the Steelers D/ST, helping push his Round 3+ production to 101.1 points in a 122.96-point win.

Brett Gets Stars and Support

Brett's first two picks combined for 49.4 points, one of the strongest starts to any draft in Week 1. But his roster didn't stop there, as another 89.6 points came from players drafted after Round 2 on the way to a 138.96-point performance.

Wayne's Stars Can't Do It Alone

Wayne received a league-best 53.9 points from Rounds 1–2, nearly half of his entire 112.30-point total. That was still good enough to finish 6th in league scoring, so the lineup performed reasonably well overall. The issue was balance. Week 1 winners averaged only 37.0 points from their first two picks, with more of their production coming from the rest of the lineup. **Wayne's** stars already delivered at an elite level and it still wasn't enough to win, which puts more pressure on the middle and later rounds to contribute when that early-round production inevitably fluctuates.

THE MIDDLE MADE THE DIFFERENCE

Week 1 winners averaged 37.2 points from Rounds 5–9, compared with just 24.6 for losing teams, a 12.6-point advantage.
That gap mattered in a week where half of all matchups were decided by less than 12.6 points. The middle rounds didn't decide every game, but they provided the kind of extra production that can swing a close matchup.